17.6 Malnutrition in Children

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Mother says • "She eats very little." **Objective** • Weight-for-height below −3 • SD • Wasting easy to see • Mid-upper arm circumference low	**ACTUAL** **Imbalanced nutrition: less than body requirements** related to inadequate intake as evidenced by severe wasting.	Gains weight steadily in the rehabilitation phase.	• Follow the therapeutic feeding protocol (start slowly). • Weigh every day. • Give micronutrients as prescribed. • Treat any infection as ordered.	Gaining weight: **goal met**.
Subjective • Mother says • "I did not know what to feed her." **Objective** • Eats mostly tea and bread • No meat or eggs at all	**ACTUAL** **Deficient knowledge (parent)** related to child nutrition as evidenced by inadequate diet.	Mother plans balanced meals.	• Teach which nutritious foods are available locally. • Teach small meals, often. • Book follow-up at the nutrition clinic.	Plans meals: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Severely malnourished • Temperature 36.0 °C	**RISK** **Risk for hypothermia** as evidenced by risk factors: low body fat.	Temperature stays at 36.5–37.5 °C.	• Keep her warm, covered and close to her mother. • Watch the temperature. • Check glucose.	Temperature normal: **goal met**.